

Question:

A 53-year-old man presents to a physician with repeated episodes of joint pain and fever for the last 3 months. The pain is present in the knee joints and small joints of the hands bilaterally. He recorded his temperature at home which never increased above 37.8°C (100.0°F). The medical history is significant for an acute myocardial infarction 1 year ago, with sustained ventricular tachycardia as a complication, for which he has been taking procainamide. The vital signs are as follows: pulse 88/min, blood pressure 134/88 mm Hg, respiratory rate 13/min, and temperature 37.2°C (99.0°F). On physical examination, he has mild joint swelling. A radiologic evaluation of the involved joints does not suggest osteoarthritis or rheumatoid arthritis. Based on the laboratory evaluation, the physician suspects that the joint pain and fever may be due to the use of procainamide. Which of the following serologic finding is most likely to be present in this patient?

Answer Choices:

- A. Presence of anti-dsDNA antibodies
- B. Decreased serum C4 level
- C. Decreased serum C3 level
- D. Presence of anti-histone antibodies

Reasoning + Answer:

< answer > B . Decreased serum C4 level </ answer >

